

*Education*

University of California, Los Angeles  
B.A. Applied Linguistics, 2021-2025

Study Abroad, National Taiwan University, Summer 2023

*Research Experience*

Speech and Cognitive Development Lab, Department of  
Linguistics, UCLA

Principal Investigator: Dr. Meg Cychosz

*Research Assistant*, September 2023–June 2025

- Lead eye-tracking data collection with children aged 3 to 5 for studies concerning language development in children with cochlear implants
- Assisted in fNIRS data collection with infants
- Administered vocabulary and articulation assessments (PPVT, GFTA, CTOPP) and hearing screenings to preschoolers
- Scored standardized assessments

Department of Psychology, UCLA

Principal Investigator: Dr. Lindy Comstock

*Research Assistant*, January–June 2023

- Completed EEG data collection with adult participants

*Work Experience*

*Fulbright English Teaching Assistant*, August 2025–present

Chenggong Elementary School, Xipan Elementary School, and Wanxing Junior High School, Changhua County, Taiwan

- Plan and co-teach 12 English lessons per week with five local English teachers
- Planned and implemented pen pal project between elementary English as a Second Language students in Modesto, California and fifth and sixth graders in Taiwan

*Circulation Desk Assistant* at UCLA Law Library, September 2023–February 2025

*ASUCLA Student Supervisor* at Northern Lights Café, September 2022–June 2023

*Awards & Honors*

Fulbright Taiwan (Foundation for Scholarly Exchange), English Teaching Assistant Award, 2025-2026

UCLA Linguistics Departmental Highest Honors, June 2025

UCLA Linguistics Undergraduate Research Award, April 2025  
*\$1,350 in support of conference travel*

UCLA Linguistics Undergraduate Research Award, April 2025  
*\$900 in support of conference travel*

Undergraduate Research Fellows Program, UCLA, Winter 2025  
*\$3,000 scholarship & participation in research practicum course*

UCLA Dean's Honors List, 2021–2025

## ***Presentations***

“How does speech input impact children's phonological processing skills?” **Emma Montilla**, Arjun Pawar, & Meg Cychosz, at *Boston University Conference on Language Development*, November 8<sup>th</sup>, 2025 (presentation)

“How children learn phonological processing skills: an argument for the syllable” **Emma Montilla**, Arjun Pawar, & Meg Cychosz, at *UCLA Undergraduate Research Week* (recorded talk, May 2025)

“A systematic review and meta-analysis of the development of coarticulation in child speech” Atlas Boulom, Coralie Cram, Nicholas Guymon, John McGahay, Zachary Metzler, **Emma Montilla**, Vishwas Shetty, Jian-Leat Siah, & Meg Cychosz at the *188<sup>th</sup> Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*, May 22<sup>nd</sup> 2025 (poster)

“Musical Multilingualism: Constraints and Creativity in Spanish-English Bilingual Songwriting” Renee Rubanowitz, **Emma Montilla**, Cia Evangelino, Saffiya Haque, Allie Kuo, & Daria Bahtina at *Cornell Undergraduate Linguistics Conference*, April 27<sup>th</sup> 2025 (poster)

“Community-oriented psycholinguistics: a holistic approach” **Emma Montilla**, Amy Martinez, Sonia Patrizi, Christina Blomquist, Nicole Nguyen, & Meg Cychosz at the *Conference on Human Sentence Processing*, University of Maryland, College Park, March 28<sup>th</sup> & 29<sup>th</sup> 2025 (poster)

“Bilingual language development in children with hearing loss”, presented by Meg Cychosz, with **Emma Montilla**, Julianna Gross, Amy Martinez, & Sonia Patrizi at *Building Connections* (talk at 3-day virtual retreat for families of children with hearing loss), April 2024

Issues in Bilingualism panel moderator, *University of California Undergraduate Conference on Slavic and East/Central European Studies*, April 2024

## *Volunteering*

*Conversation partner* (Mandarin-English), at Lumos Café English Nights, Changhua City, Taiwan, September 2025–present

*Childcare volunteer*, John Tracy Center (Los Angeles education and treatment center for preschoolers with hearing loss), January–June 2025

*Language exchange partner* (Mandarin-English), UCLA Dashew Center for International Students, 2023–2024

## *Languages*

English, Mandarin Chinese

## *Skills*

Hardware: EyeLink 1000 (eye-tracking), EEG  
Software: Qualtrics, Praat, REDCap, basic Python, basic R  
Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, and Word

## *Relevant Coursework*

Speech Production (graduate course), Applied Phonetics, Experimental Phonetics, Language Development, Bilingualism, Heritage Language Linguistics, Python for Social Sciences, Intro to Psychology, Intro to Statistics

## *References*

Meg Cychosz, Assistant Professor of Linguistics, Stanford  
mcychosz@stanford.edu

Daria Bahtina, Continuing Lecturer of Linguistics, UCLA  
bahtina@ucla.edu

Jen Yang, Changhua County Coordinator, Fulbright Taiwan  
jyang@fse.fulbright.org.tw